FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

BALANCING SCHOOL & SPORT

Homework, exams and a busy training week

22

THE QUICK VERSION

> School and sport can work brilliantly together. Active kids often concentrate better and manage their time well. But a packed week can also lead to stress, late nights and burnout. A simple plan helps your child give their best to both, without running on empty.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

Young players often juggle school, homework, training, games, travel, friends and family. When exams arrive or the season gets busy, something has to give. Teaching your child to plan their week, ask for help and make choices is a life skill that goes far beyond football.

BUILD A WEEKLY GAME PLAN

1

MAP IT

On Sunday, write down the week: school, training, games, homework and family plans.

2

PLAN THE GAPS

Find homework time around training. Short, focused sessions work best.

3

PROTECT REST

Keep at least one evening free, and make sure sleep isn't squeezed.

Exam time? Adjust, don't abandon

During exams, it's okay to reduce training for a few weeks. Keeping some sport can actually help with stress and focus. Talk to the coach early so they can plan around it.

Success occurs when opportunity meets preparation.

TRY THIS

1. **Use the car ride**
   Quick revision quizzes or reading on the way to training.
2. **Pack a snack and a plan**
   A good after-school snack and a clear plan for homework time.
3. **Talk to teachers and coaches**
   Both are usually happy to help when they know the situation.
4. **Watch for stress signs**
   Tiredness, irritability or slipping grades can signal too much on.
5. **Let them have a say**
   Ask your child what feels too much and what they want to prioritise.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"Let's plan your week together."	~~"Football or school, you can't do both."~~
"What's feeling hardest right now?"	~~"Stop complaining, everyone's busy."~~
"It's okay to train less during exams."	~~"You can't miss a single session."~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] We plan the week together
- [ ] Homework has a regular time slot
- [ ] There's at least one free evening
- [ ] The coach knows about exam periods

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

Balancing school and football teaches discipline, time management and priorities, which are skills that last long after your playing days are over.

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM